

Document: EU countries seek flexibility over green steel and cement quotas

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【要点】

- ・ EU加盟国は、気候に優しい建築材料の製造を促進する法律の修正権をブリュッセルに付与することを求めており、環境目標の弱体化を図ろうとしている。
- ・ 産業加速化法案は低炭素鋼とアルミニウムの使用割合を25%、セメントを5%とする義務的クォータを設定しているが、加盟国はこれが材料価格上昇と競争力低下につながると懸念している。
- ・ 加盟国は、材料コスト上昇や低炭素材料の供給不足の場合、委員会がクォータの時間枠と割合を変更できる権限を与えるよう提案している。
- ・ EUは過去2年間、中国やアメリカとの競争力維持の懸念から、環境規制を次々と緩和する傾向を続けている。
- ・ 当該提案はまだ最終版ではなく、欧州議会と欧州委員会との協議を経て法律が成立する予定である。

【メール原文】

BRUSSELS — EU countries want to give Brussels the power to revise a law designed to boost the manufacture of climate-friendly building materials, in t

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By James Fernyhough, Tom Schmidtgen, Francesca Micheletti · Aug 3, 2026, 1:02 PM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — EU countries want to give Brussels the power to revise a law designed to boost the manufacture of climate-friendly building materials, in the latest attempt to water down the bloc's environmental ambitions.

The Industrial Accelerator Act , proposed by the European Commission in March, would require "low-carbon" steel and aluminum to make up 25 percent of those materials used in publicly-commissioned works. For cement, the proposed quota is 5 percent.

The idea is for mandatory quotas to guarantee demand and prompt industry to find cleaner ways to manufacture the most polluting materials.

But according to a new text dated July 30 and obtained by POLITICO , member countries are worried this rule could reduce the EU's access to vital materials, push up prices, and damage its ability to compete with China and the U.S.

The text proposes giving the Commission the power to change the rules "to amend the timeframe of application and percentage shares of the Union origin and low-carbon requirements" for steel, cement

and aluminum.

The Commission could use this power if the law is deemed to be pushing up the cost of materials and threatening European competitiveness. It could also use it if supply of “low-carbon” materials is limited, or if the rules are deemed to be damaging EU’s production capacity and threatening security of supply.

Under the original Commission proposal , low-carbon quotas for aluminum and cement, but not steel, would need to be made in the EU. Member countries propose extending the EU-made requirement to steel.

The text is not final and would still need to debate with the European Parliament and the Commission before the law is enacted.

The proposal continues a trend of green backsliding that has dominated EU policymaking for the last two years, driven by fears that the EU’s ambitious climate policies are harming its ability to compete with dirtier economies like China and the U.S.

Major EU climbdowns in recent months include paring back green reporting rules for businesses, cancelling a plan to ban the sale of gasoline-powered cars, weakening the EU’s emissions trading scheme , and allowing member countries to use international carbon credits to help meet their domestic pollution reduction targets.

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